Philo & Xeni

the love of strangers

SUPSI MAInD X SPARK REPLY

Gürünlü Günseli, Nerea Asensio, Mélanie Turano, Peng-Hsuan Lee Jennifer, Walter De Nicola

Selected context

In traditional hospitality, entire departments handle what one P2P host manages alone.

HOTEL DISTRIBUTED TEAMS

- BOH - Back of house
- FOH - Front of house
- Back office - Admin & Finance

P2P SINGLE OPERATOR

- BOH - Cleaning
- FOH - Guest care
- Back office - Pricing ⇢ One host

WEARS EVERY HAT

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airbnb

- Largest P2P platform in Europe
- Most contested by cities and communities
- Widest gat between brand promise and lived experience

Airbnb is out design context. But the problem is bigger than one platform.

The problem isn’t Airbnb, it’s the model

Across the system, every actor is optimising for the wrong thing.

PLATFORMS

Profit from ~~quality~~ volume

MORE LISTINGS, MORE TAKE-RATE

HOSTS

Optimised for ~~identity~~ occupancy

CALENDARS BEAT CHARACTER

GUESTS

Filtered by ~~experience~~ price

CHEAPEST WINS THE SEARCH

SO WHAT

A solution owned by one platform will always serve that platform first. The agent needs to sit above them: starting with Airbnb, built to go further.

The gap between what hosts know and what guests find is worth billions.

€100B+

EUROPEAN SHORT-TERM RENTAL MARKET (2025)

5M+

HOSTS WITH LOCAL KNOWLEDGE THAT NEVER REACHES GUESTS

68%

OF TRAVELLERS CITE LOCAL AUTHENTICITY AS PRIMARY CRITERION

<15%

OF LISTINGS INCLUDE A GUIDEBOOK OR LOCAL RECOMMENDATIONS

No existing tool connects territory intelligence, host identity, and guest preference into a single experience. That gap is where we work.

Research & insights

3 tracks · 4 interviews · 11 forum voices · academic papers + platform analysis

Two sides of the same stay. The tension between them.

HOST SIDE A

From community to business

1. **Hosting becomes management** - operations crowd out hospitality.
2. **Differentiation is unclear** - listings blur into one another.
3. **Local value is underused** - neighborhood knowledge stays invisible.

> *"I know this area better than anyone. But I can't figure out how to put that in a listing."*
>
> *-Host interview*

GUEST SIDE B

The nudge of connection

1. **Value is communicated** only when it's relevant in the moment.
2. **Guests seek local connection** beyond the four walls of a stay.
3. **Price is prioritised** over experience by default.

> *"Every listing description feels the same. I can't tell if I'd actually like staying there."*
>
> *-Guest interview*

HMW How might we build an intelligence layer that gives P2P platforms the tools to deliver personalised, locally rooted experiences that neither hosts nor guests could access alone?

Two sides of the same problem. Two sides of the same solution.

What each side is asking for.

HOST SET UP TO STAND OUT

Set up to stand out.

1. **Faster, simpler path to listing**
   A guided way to set up and manage their listing without losing their personal voice.

2. **Express identity**
   Tools to express what makes their place and their hosting style unique.

GUEST FIND THE FEELING

Find the feeling, not just the place.

1. **Search the feeling**
   A stay that matches **the feeling they're looking for,** not just the filters.

2. **Personalised recommendations**
   Local, host-specific recommendations that make the stay feel **curated, not generic.**

Our users



Meet **Marco**

The Evolving Host

- 35 y.o
- Has some experience but lacks a clear direction.
- Deep local knowledge, never formalised into a listing identity
- Manages his property remotely or semi-remotely



Meet **Sofia**

The Experience Seeker

- 28 y.o
- Frequent traveller
- Travels for experiences, not just accommodation
- Filters don’t capture what she’s looking for
- Values local, personal recommendations

Every **place has a story**. Every person has a **way of experiencing it**. The agent is the **intelligence layer** that brings the two together learning who you are, understanding where you are, and **connecting** you to the **people** who make a **place** worth knowing.

Adaptive, effortless, and unlike anything a platform alone could offer.

φιλοξενία

the love of strangers

Hi! I’m Philo, your listing co-pilot

‘the love of’

Optimise

Conversational assistant for hosts building or optimising their space. Also surfaces relevant stays for guests during search.

Hi! I’m Xeni, your guidebook co-pilot

‘the stranger’

Wander

Voice guided map itinerary curated by hosts. Activated when guests explore a destination. Surfaces local knowledge, routes and place stories.

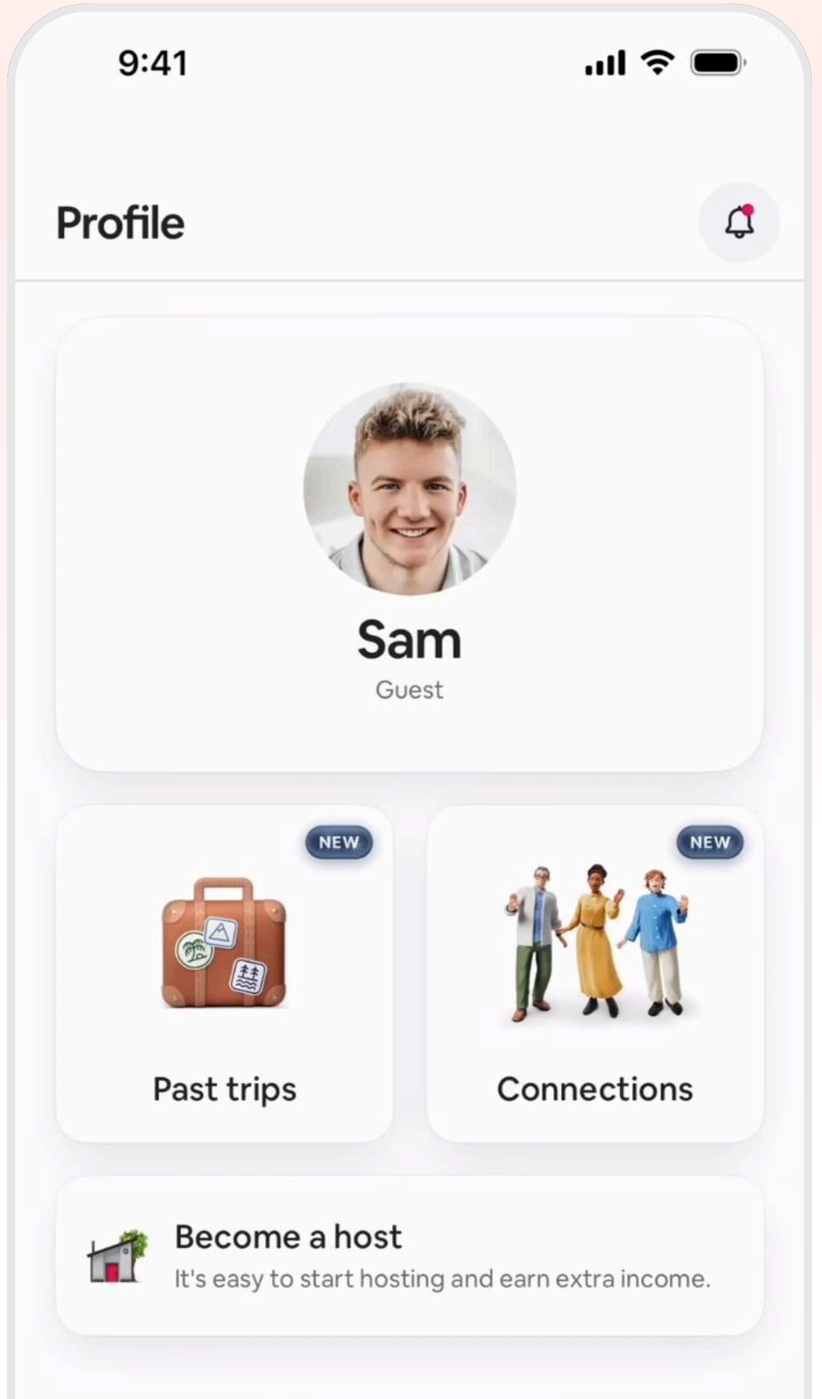
Two agents. Four roles. One shared intelligence.

	Philo the listing co-pilot	Xeni the guidebook co-pilot
01 **For the host**	**Builds the listing** Extracts, positions and generates from host voice.	**Builds the guidebook** Co-creates with territory intelligence and host stories.
02 **For the guest**	**Finds the stay** Searches by mood, style and experience — not price.	**Delivers the experience** Real-time companion through the guidebook.
03 **For the territory**	**Local businesses and organisations contribute verified knowledge** surfaced as genuine recommendations, not advertising.	

Optimise

Host side

There are 40+ steps to publish a listing in the Airbnb flow



9:41

Profile



Sam

Guest

NEW



Past trips

NEW



Connections



Become a host

It's easy to start hosting and earn extra income.

Account settings

Switch to hosting

Get help

Explore | Wishlists | Trips | Messages | Profile

Optimise

Host side

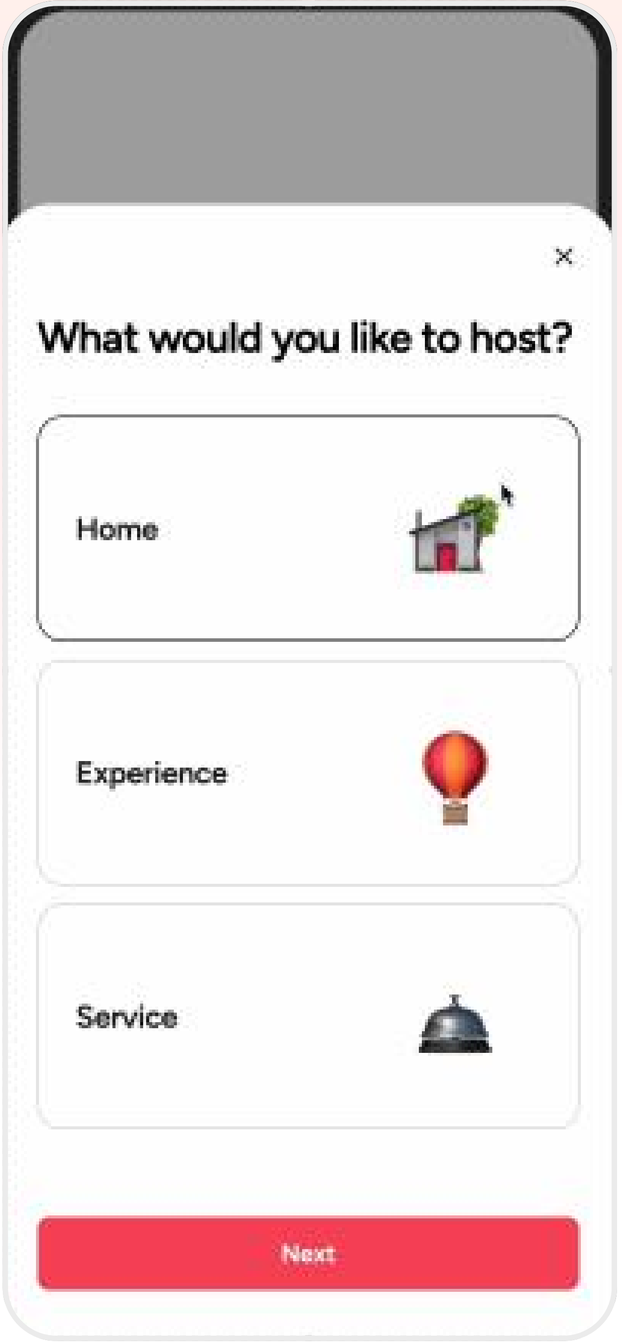
The listing sounds like you, positioned like pro.

01 ## Conversational extraction

The host describes their place by voice or text. Philo extracts property details, validates them, and fills the listing in real time.

BECAUSE

Hosts have the knowledge. They've never had the tools to turn it into a listing identity — until now.



Optimise

Host side

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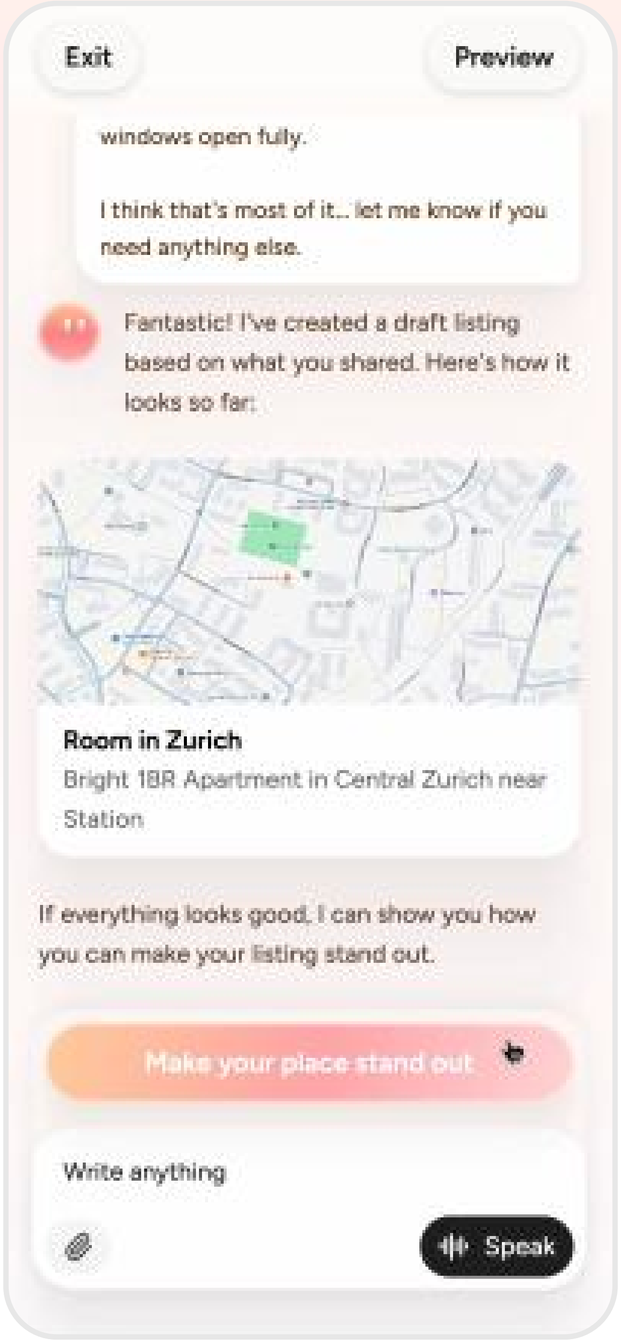
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02 **AI analysis**

Running in parallel, Philo analyses competitor listings, local demand patterns, and guest segments to position the listing strategically — not just accurately.

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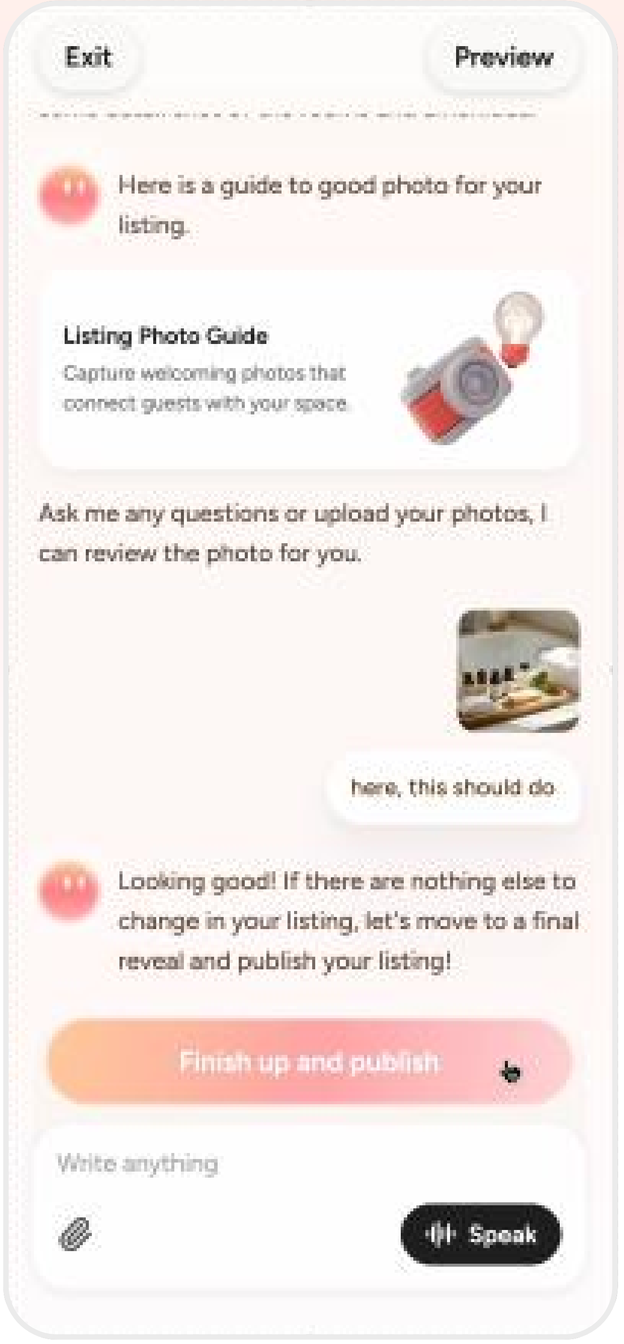
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03 **Territory intelligence**

Local context — neighbourhood character, nearby POIs, what makes the area distinct — is layered into the listing automatically.

BECAUSE

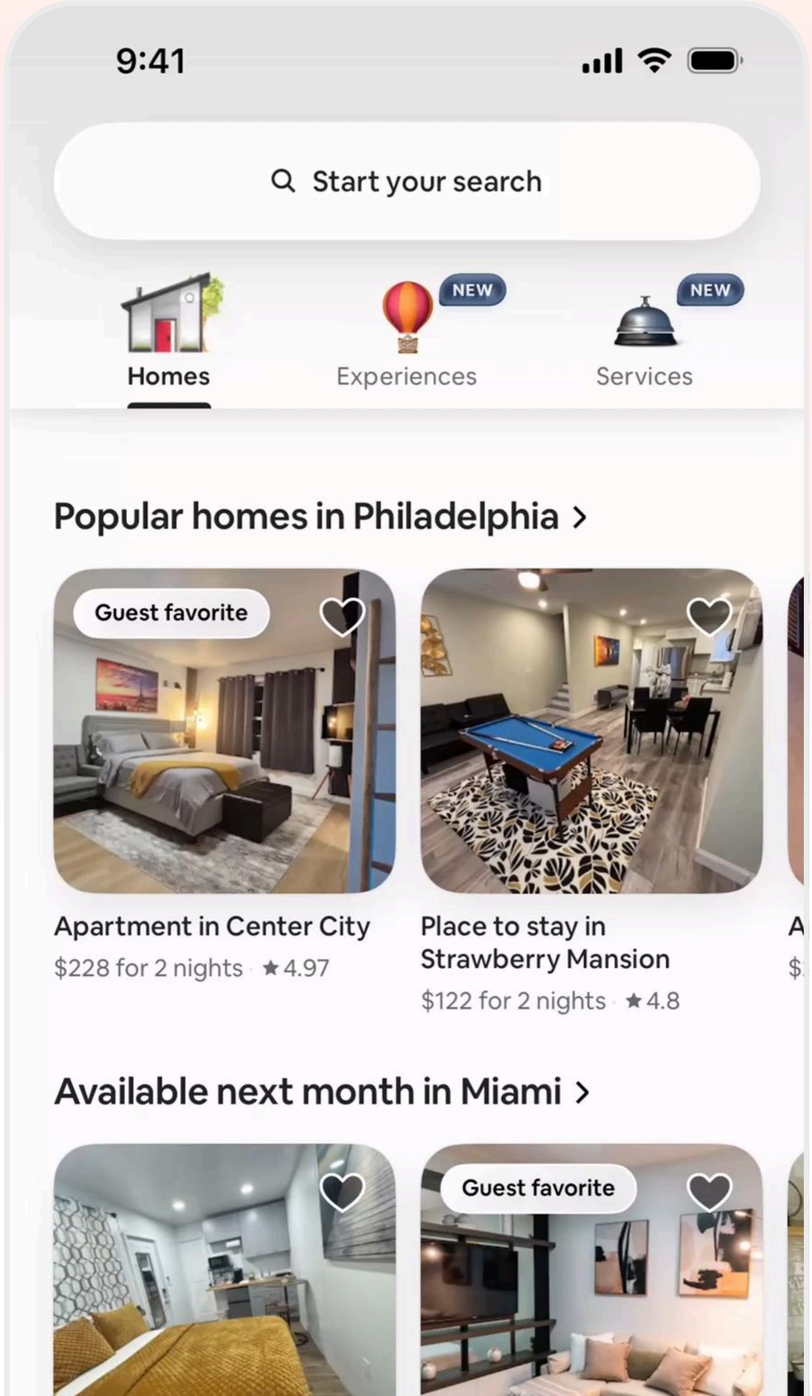
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Optimise

Guest side

Results are identical cards ranked by price and algorithms



Optimise

Guest side

Search by feeling, not by filter.

01 **Mood & intent reading**

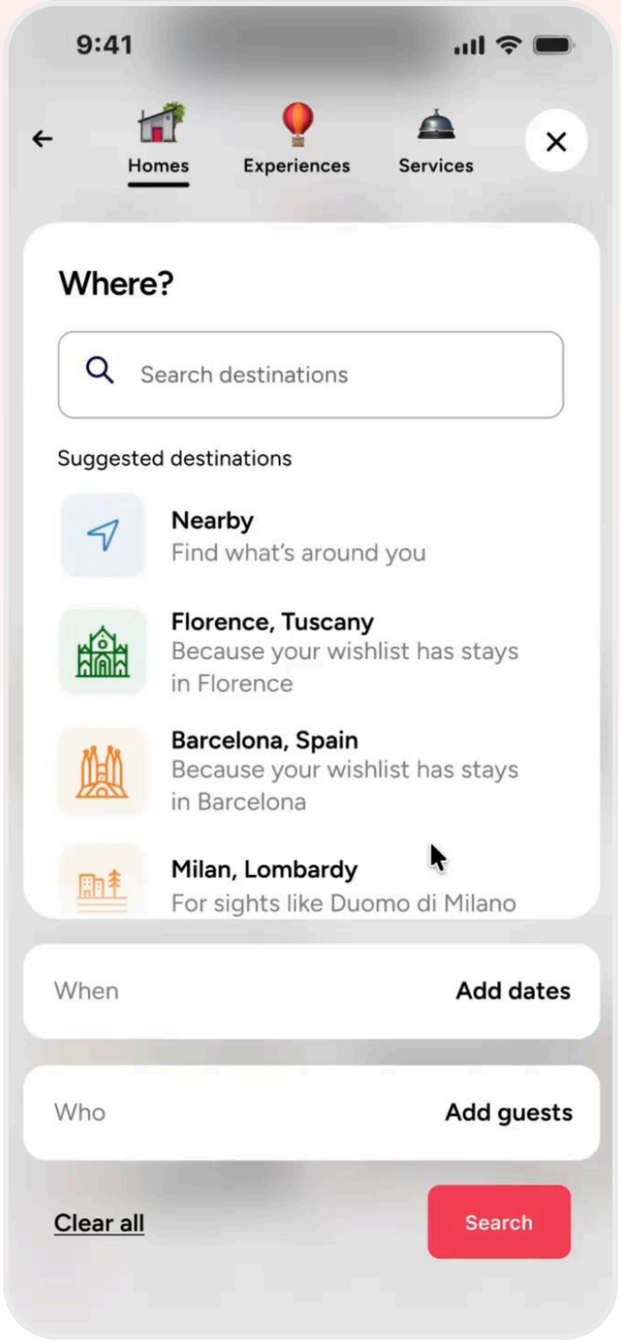
The guest describes the kind of trip they want. Philo interprets it — not as keywords, but as a travel intent.

02 **Preference learning**

Past trips, reviews left, places saved. Philo knows what you've loved and what hasn't worked.

BECAUSE

Guests know the feeling they want. Current search only responds to parameters.



Optimise

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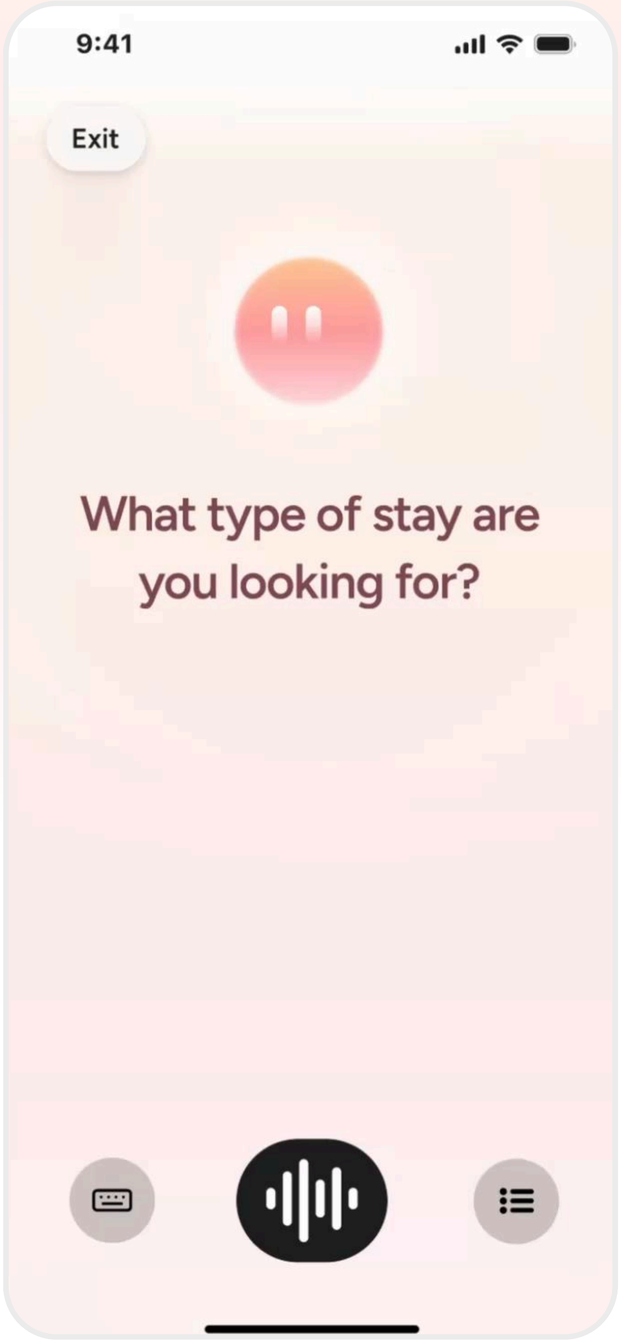
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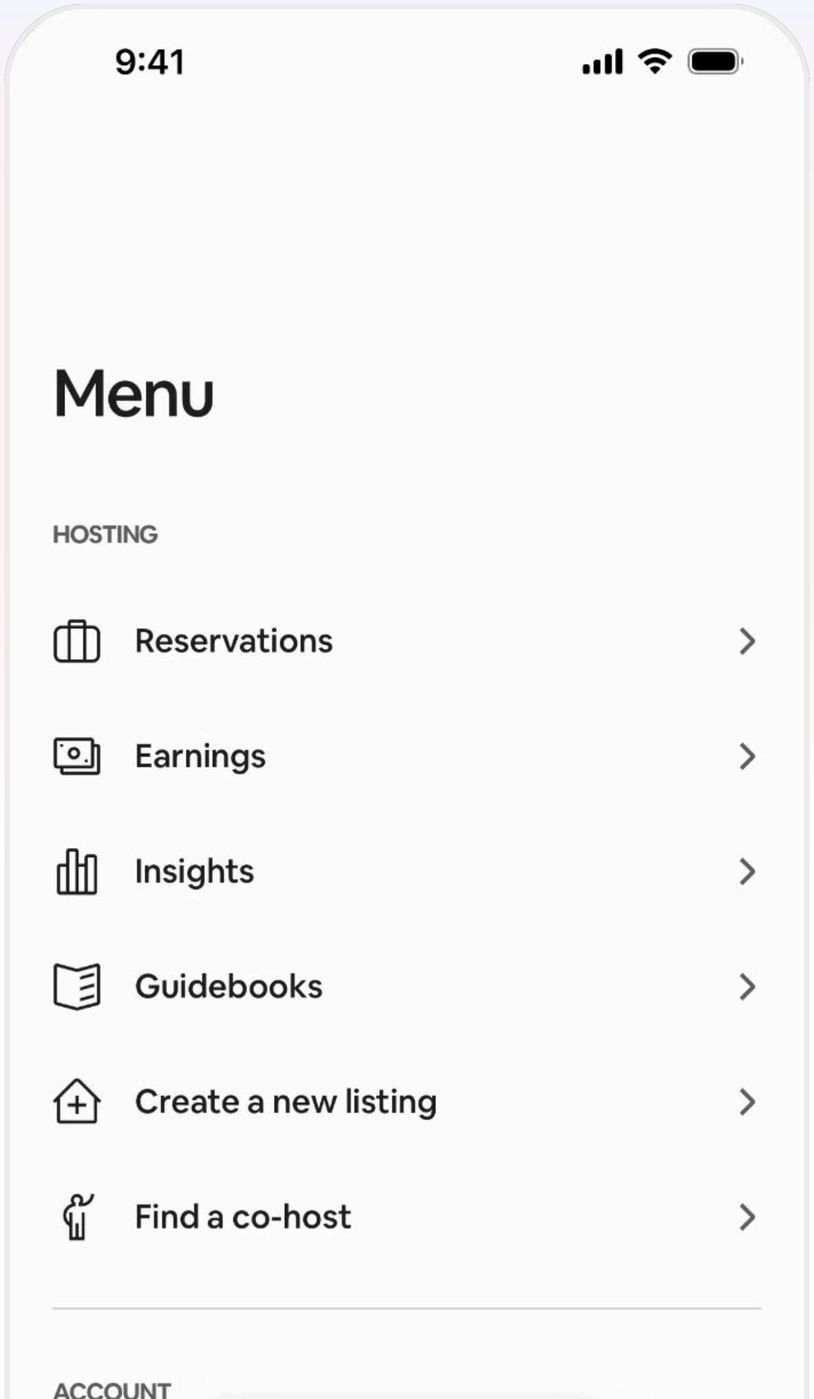
03 **Tailored recommendations**

Results aren't sorted by price or popularity. They're ranked by fit — for this person, this trip, this moment.

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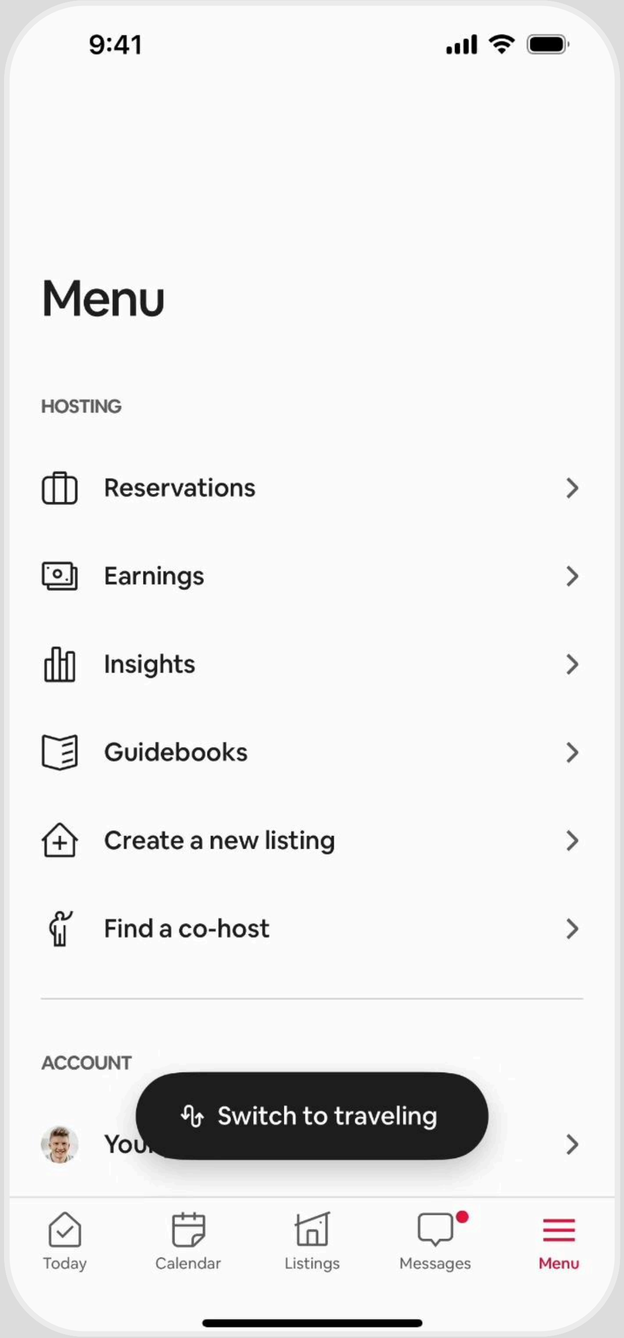




Host side

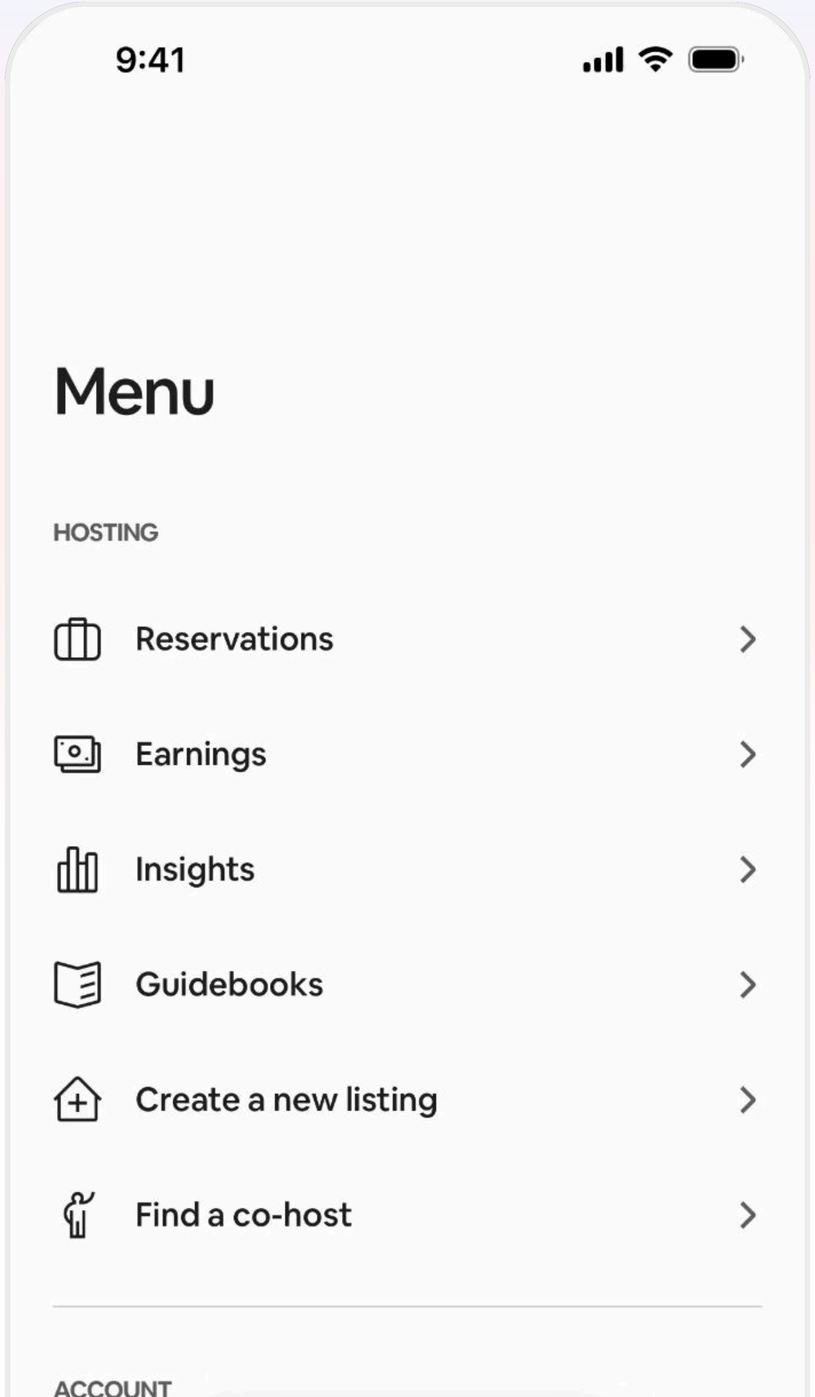
Wander

The guidebook function is valuable, but overlooked. Airbnb knows the value of customising experience.


9:41
Menu
HOSTING
Reservations
Earnings
Insights
Guidebooks
Create a new listing
Find a co-host
ACCOUNT
Switch to traveling
Today
Calendar
Listings
Messages
Menu

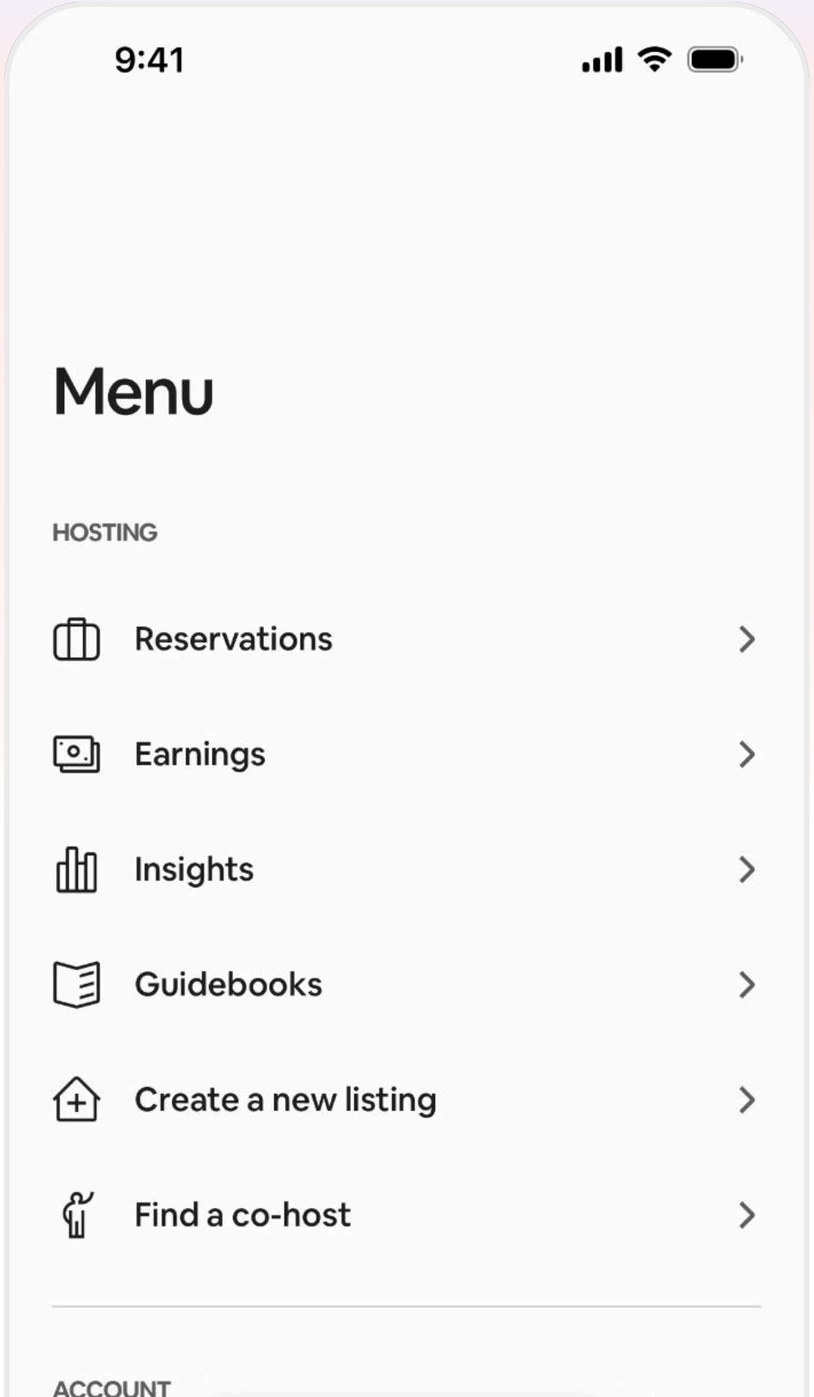
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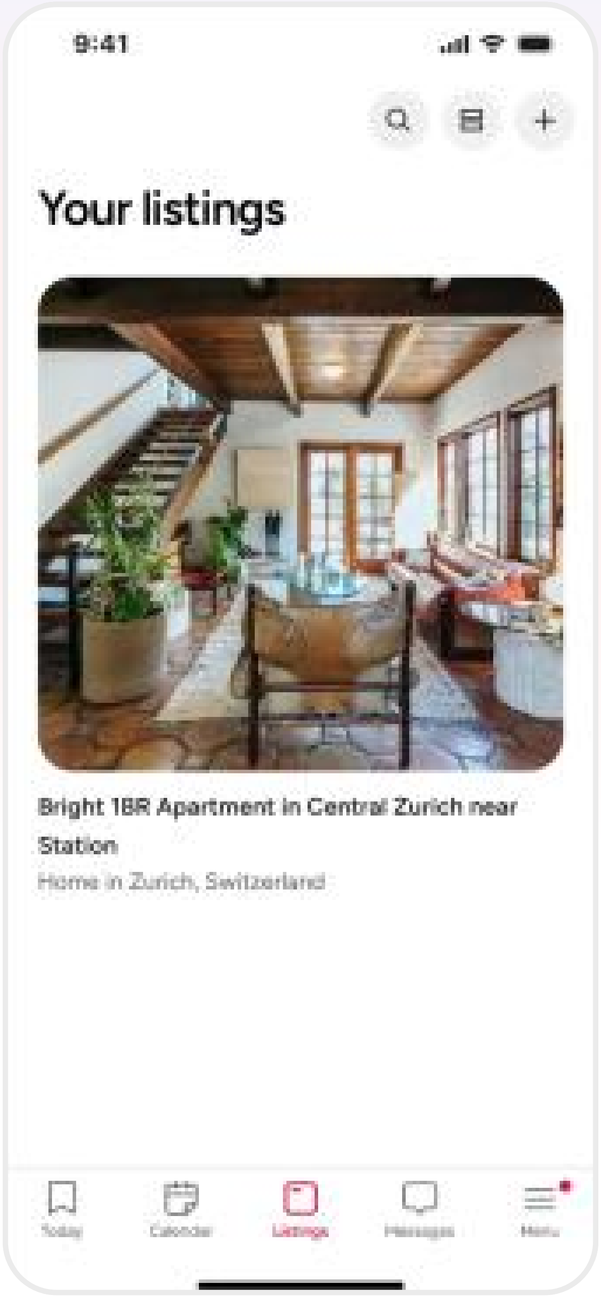
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Host side

Wander

The host's knowledge of a place, made shareable.

01 **Conversational elicitation**

Xeni asks the host about places to visit, activities, city advice, and host stories. Things that would never appear in a form field.

BECAUSE

Local value is underused. Host knowledge never reaches the guest in a meaningful way.



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Local events that weekend, recent openings, route data, area character. The guide stays relevant — not just personal.

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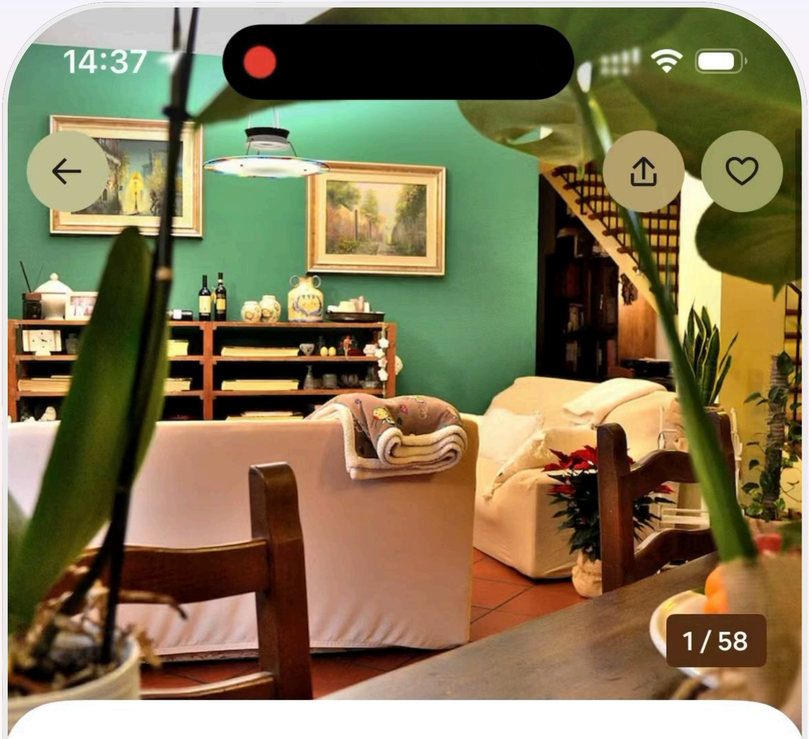
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03 Living content

The guidebook updates. What's new in the neighbourhood surfaces for the next guest — not just the one who arrived last year.

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Ensuite room center of Tuscany

Room in Poggibonsi, Italy
1 queen bed · Private attached bathroom

4.95 ★★★★★ | Guest favourite | 432 Reviews

Stay with Roberto
Superhost · 13 years hosting

Guest side

Wander

Communication is one sided, and guest doesn't build connection with hosts, no community value that was promised.



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Self check-in

Rare find! This place is usually booked

€ 120
For 2 nights · 13–15 May

Reserve

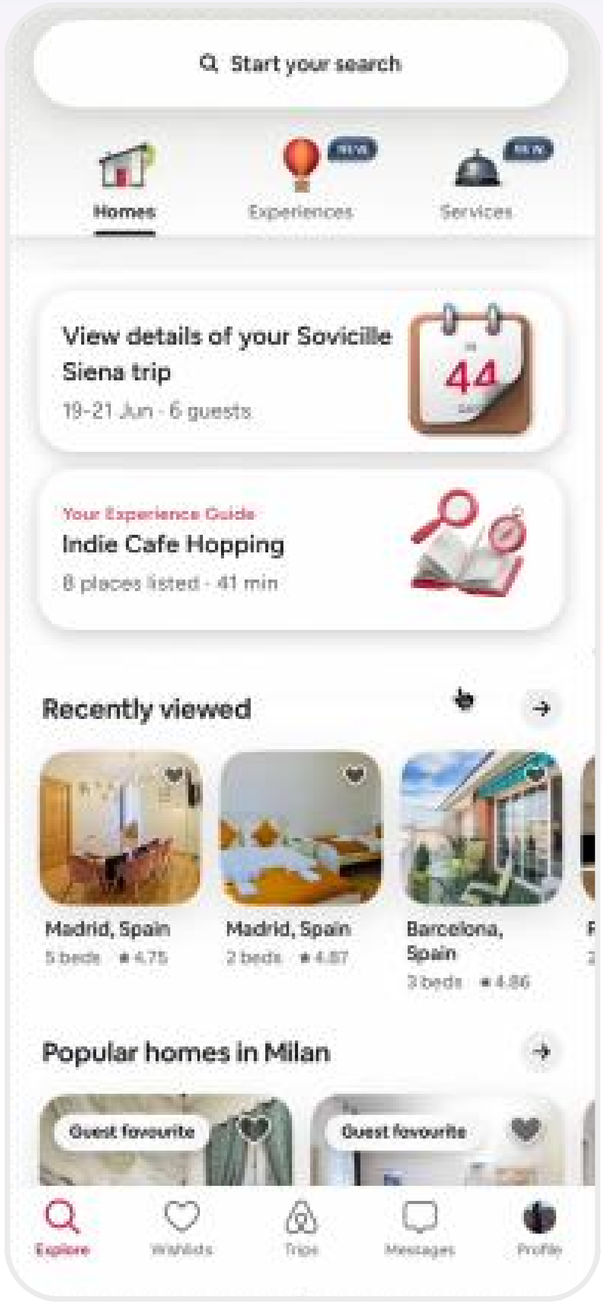


Not a list of places. A way of experiencing them, through the host's voice.

BEFORE THE STAY

The host's character comes through before check-in.

The guest previews the guide before booking: they see who the host is and how they experience their neighbourhood.



Guest side

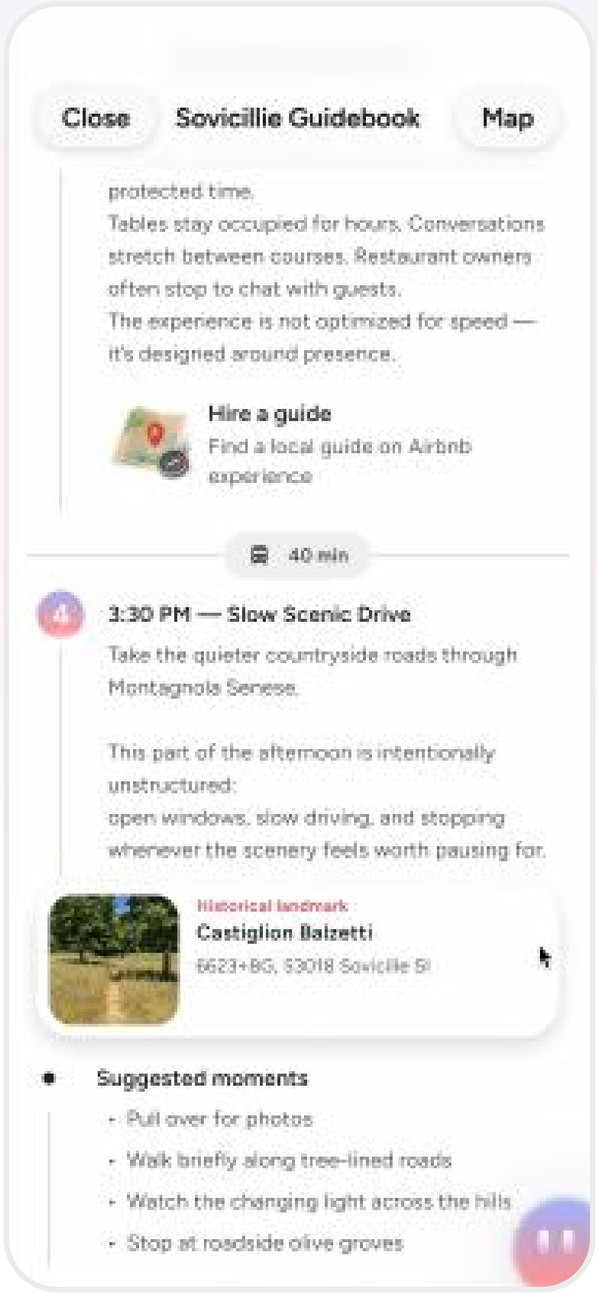
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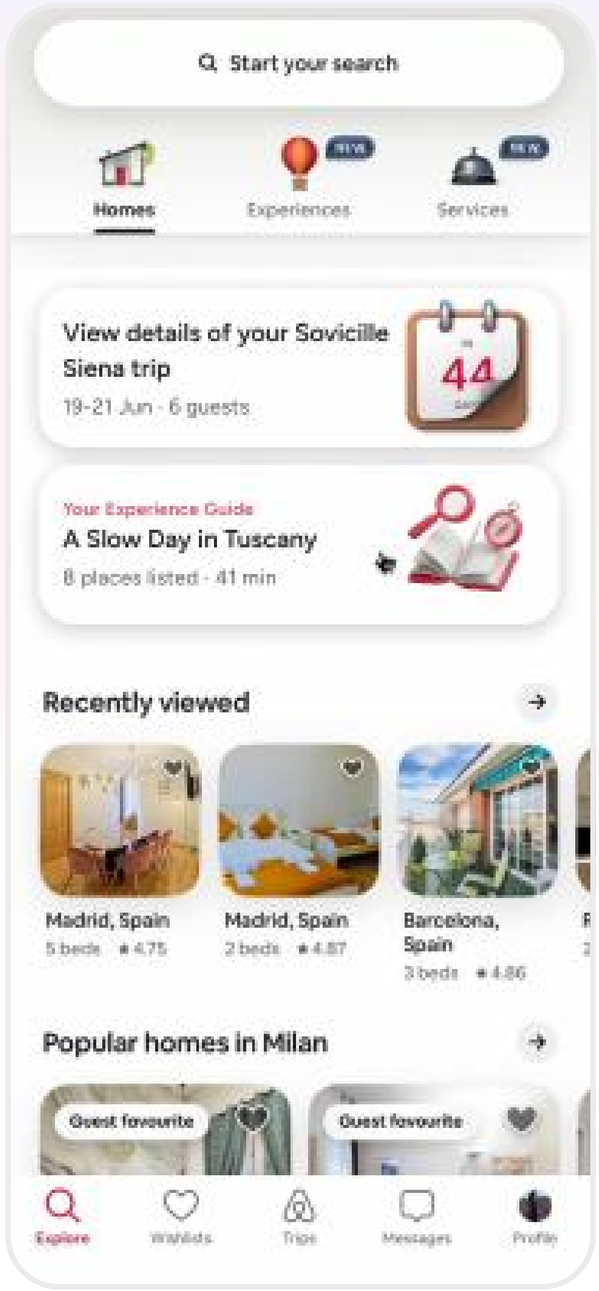
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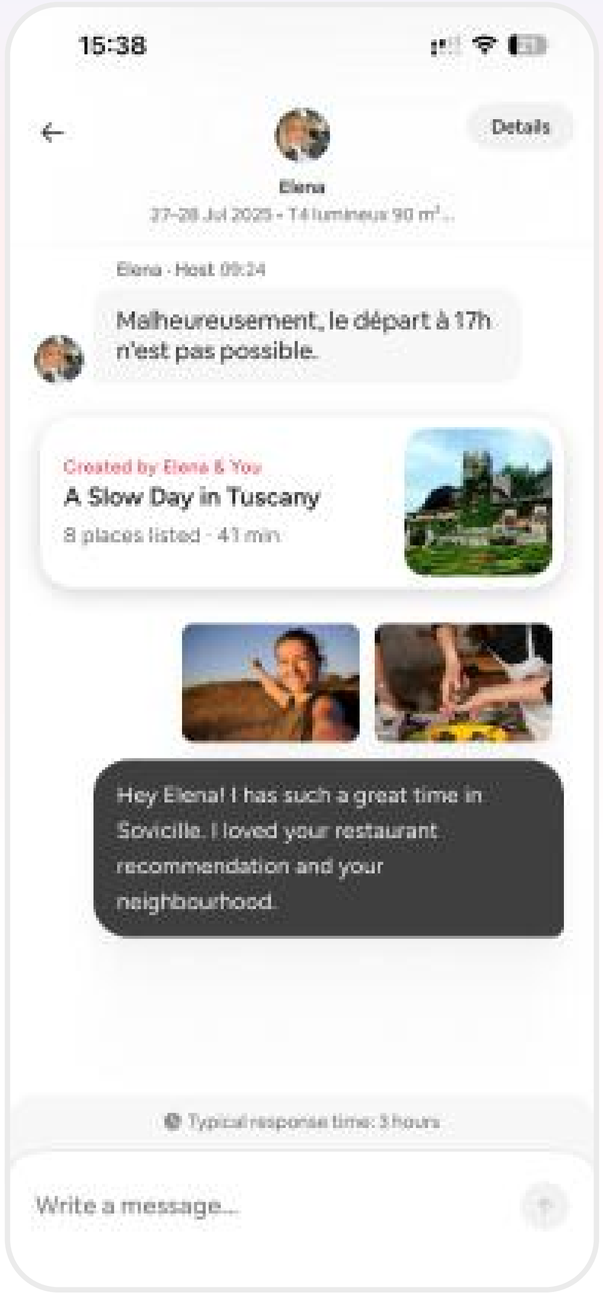
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DURING THE STAY

A narrated journey through the place.

Live map, voice narration, real-time suggestions as the guest moves through the city. The guide adapts to where they are and what they've done.



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AFTER THE STAY

The guide grows with each guest.

Guests share stories and photos. The experience feeds back into the knowledge layer, making the guide richer for the next guest.

This is φιλοξενία — the love of strangers — made into a product.

We built for Airbnb. But the intelligence belongs to no single platform.

Philo and Xeni are not Airbnb features. They are an agentic layer that sits above the platform — deployable wherever hosts, guests, and local knowledge need to connect.

A

Include

Collaboration layer with **local businesses and organisations**

B

Explore

Cross-platform integration layer across P2P landscape.

C

Extent

Beyond the app, into the physical experience

DEPLOYABLE ACROSS

HOSTELWORLD Booking.com Tripadvisor

ADJACENT TERRITORIES

P2P ACCOMMODATION | MOBILITY | RESTAURANTS & DINING | LOCAL EXPERIENCES | TRAVEL



There are no strangers here — only friends you haven’t met yet.

φιλοξενία

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